Accommodation Cancellation and Refund Policy

University of AI | Residential Services

FICTIONAL INSTITUTION - DEMONSTRATION POLICY

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1. Purpose and scope

1.1 This policy describes cancellation requests and refunds for individual residents with a confirmed University of AI accommodation booking and a scheduled arrival date on or after 1 January 2027.

1.2 It applies to cancellations before arrival. Departure after check-in, university-initiated cancellations and changes to an existing booking require individual review; no automatic refund entitlement for those situations is established here.

2. Definitions

2.1 Scheduled arrival date: the arrival date recorded in the confirmed booking. Submitting a cancellation does not change this date.

2.2 Notice days: the scheduled arrival calendar date minus the cancellation receipt calendar date, using Australia/Melbourne time. Use calendar dates, not elapsed 24-hour periods.

2.3 Accommodation prepayment: money already paid toward accommodation for the cancelled booking. The automatic refund percentages in section 3 apply only to this amount. This policy does not establish refunds for other charges.

Original fictional policy prepared for the AI Build & Test Lab portfolio. It is not issued by, or affiliated with, a real university.

Cancellation rules and requests

3. Standard pre-arrival refund

3.1 For a booking covered by section 1, apply the following schedule to the accommodation prepayment. Eligibility is determined by the receipt date in section 4, even if staff process the request later.

Notice before scheduled arrival	Refund of accommodation prepayment
21 or more calendar days	100%
7 to 20 calendar days, inclusive	60%
0 to 6 calendar days, inclusive	25%

3.2 A cancellation received on the scheduled arrival date has zero notice days and qualifies for the 25% band only if the resident has not checked in. A request received after that date, or after check-in, is referred for review under section 1.2.

3.3 Calculate refund = accommodation prepayment multiplied by the applicable percentage. Round once to the nearest Australian cent using half-up rounding. If the accommodation prepayment is zero, the refund is zero. No additional cancellation deduction applies to this calculation.

4. Submitting and recording a cancellation

4.1 Submit a cancellation through the Campus Support Portal for the relevant booking. Before submission, the portal shows the booking, scheduled arrival date and cancellation summary for the resident to confirm.

4.2 The receipt time is when the backend successfully records the request, not when a chat message is drafted or sent. A successful submission returns a cancellation reference and receipt time.

4.3 If the portal cannot record the request, it must show a failure and must not claim that cancellation succeeded. A resident may contact Residential Services through the portal help channel. A staff-recorded request uses its recorded receipt time; any correction requires an authorised, auditable review.

4.4 Repeated submission for an already cancelled booking must return the existing cancellation reference without creating a second cancellation or refund.

5. Worked examples

5.1 A booking has a scheduled arrival date of 1 March 2027 and an accommodation prepayment of AUD 1,000. A request recorded on 8 February 2027 has 21 notice days: the standard refund is AUD 1,000.

5.2 For the same booking, a request recorded on 9 February 2027 has 20 notice days: the standard refund is AUD 600. These examples assume the resident has not checked in.

Exceptions and administration

6. Exceptional circumstances

6.1 A resident may request an exceptional-circumstances review, for example after a documented visa refusal, serious illness or withdrawal of their course offer. These circumstances do not automatically change the standard refund.

6.2 Submit the review request and supporting evidence through the portal within 10 business days after the cancellation receipt date. For this demonstration policy, business days are Monday to Friday; public holidays are not excluded. Counting starts on the next business day.

6.3 An authorised Residential Services reviewer decides whether to increase the standard refund and records the reason. Any revised refund must be no lower than the standard refund and no higher than the accommodation prepayment. The assistant cannot approve an exception.

7. Processing and review

7.1 Residential Services aims to issue the refund decision within 5 business days after receiving a complete request, including any required evidence. This is a service target, not a guarantee of bank settlement.

7.2 An approved refund is initiated to the original payment method within 10 business days after approval. If that method cannot receive the refund, staff must verify an alternative method with the resident before initiation. Bank settlement may take additional time.

7.3 A resident may request reconsideration within 10 business days after the decision notification. A different authorised reviewer records the outcome and explanation. A review does not create an automatic entitlement to a larger refund.

8. Responsibilities and information access

8.1 Residents must check the booking details and supply accurate information. Residential Services verifies eligibility, records decisions and arranges approved refunds.

8.2 Residents may view their own booking and cancellation records. Staff access must be limited to their authorised institution and role. The assistant must not disclose another resident's records.

8.3 Policy answers must distinguish standard rules from decisions requiring staff review. A policy explanation does not itself cancel a booking, approve an exception or initiate payment.

9. Version control

9.1 Version 1.0 is the initial demonstration release. Later editions must identify their effective date and transition rule. A future edition must not be applied solely because its upload date is newer.

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